

WARLOCK

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ELVES

WARLOCK

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MYSTERIES OF THE LOST ELVEN COURTS

by Sarah Madsen

The elven courts once spanned much of Midgard, shining and elegant in their splendor. With the passing of the Great Retreat, many of these once-grand courts were left abandoned, slowly relenting to the passing of time and decay. Some of these courts still house residents of one type or another, whether Arbonesse exiles that refused to leave their homes, servants who were abandoned when the Last Horn sounded, or unnamed entities that have moved into the abandoned halls like hermit crabs into an empty shell.

The elves built their cities in wild and beautiful places. With access to the fey roads, few elves worried about passage overland, so courts that were tricky to reach during their heyday are practically impossible to approach now. These forests are filled with deadly and terrifying threats, and the roads are choked by centuries of undergrowth. The elves' lands have been reclaimed by nature, by the unquiet dead, or by their own descendants. Mysteries abound within these lost courts, and rumors spin ever wilder tales of what lies within the ruined grandeur of the elven holdings.

For more on elven courts, see *Warlock 7: Fey Courts*.

CLOUD DRAGON COURT (TOMIERRAN FOREST)

To the east of the Arbonesse lies the Tomierran Forest. Once the home of not one but two elven courts, the Tomierran now hides more secrets than it gives answers. Nearest to the Greater Duchy of Morgau, the forest's proximity to the undead empire means it sees more than its fair share of incursions, but its stewardship under Saintmistress Rowanmantle keeps the undead from encroaching too far.

Overshadowed by the infamous ruins of Thorn, the remnants of the Cloud Dragon Court are far less flashy. Paired with its seclusion deep in the forest, it has seen far fewer tomb raiders and adventurers than the former elven capital. Even those that know of the court's existence are hesitant to make the journey—the risks of delving into the Tomierran are great indeed, and the rewards are unknown.

Triple Spires. During its height, the Cloud Dragon Court held three main spires. These thin towers stretched ever upward, reaching far past the tops of the trees, a marvel of elven

construction and magic. The three spires were called the Star Spire, the Moon Spire, and the Sun Spire, and they formed a perfect triangle at the center of the city.

Each of these spires contained dozens of small chambers and a long spiral staircase that terminated at an open cupola with a domed cap. Here it was possible to look out over the entirety of the Tomierran. On a clear day, one could glimpse the Nieder Straits to the north past the twisting branches of Holda's Tree.

The spires were connected by the three long sides of the Hastate Conservatory, a soaring glass spire atop a triangular white-stone courtyard. Elves moved through these hallways in quiet contemplation or picnicked in the courtyard with the Dreamer's Cloud hovering between the spires far above.

The day the elves left the halls of the Cloud Dragon Court and took their magic with them, the spires collapsed to the earth far below them, shattering stone and glass alike. All that now remains of the fallen towers is a forest of debris and three jagged stumps of white stone.

DREAM MAGIC SPELLS

Dream magic uses the malleability of dreams to harness and channel arcane power.

DREAMSTRIDE

*3rd-Level Illusion (Dream, Ritual Only) |
Druid, Wizard*

Casting Time: 10 minutes

Range: Self

Components: V, S

Duration: Concentration, up to 10 minutes

You reach out with your consciousness and step into the dreams of another creature in order to view a memory or gather information. The creature must be on the same plane of existence as you and have a minimum Intelligence score of 7. If the target is not asleep or in meditation (in the case of elves or similar races) when the spell is cast, the spell fails. This spell has no effect on constructs or undead.

When you cast the spell, you enter your target's dream, and you view the events as an invisible third party. The creature is unaware of your presence, and you cannot interact with the dream in any way other than the method listed below.

As an action, you can reach out your consciousness and attempt to influence the course of the dream. For example, you may

FORGOTTEN SCHOOL: DREAM MAGIC

The arcane practitioners of the Cloud Dragon Court were the progenitors of a lost school of elven high magic: dream magic. Dream magic allowed the elves to use dreams for a multitude of purposes: divination through *oneiromancy*, research and espionage through *dreamstride*, or even using a *phantasm* to assassinate an enemy from a distance while they lie dreaming.

Given elves' non-slumbering nature, dream magic was incredibly difficult to master, and many elven mages thought it folly to dedicate so much time and study to an art that may

well be out of the reach of their kind. Others thought it a passing fad or a fringe offshoot of liminal magic that would be absorbed into other spellcraft or eventually fade away. Indeed, the elves of the Cloud Dragon Court may never have created, practiced, or mastered dream magic without the aid of a particularly powerful ally: Kalikamore, the Dreamer.

Few artifacts or records remain of dream magic, but a scroll or book may be found within the broken ruins of the Cloud Dragon Court.

cause something new to appear or cause the tone of the dream to change to a nightmare (or vice-versa) or influence a “character” in the dream other than the target to act a certain way. When you attempt to influence the dream, your target must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC. On a failed save, your attempt to alter the dream is successful. On a successful save, you are immediately ejected from the dream as the dreamer awakens.

For the duration of the spell, your body lies in repose in the location you cast the spell. You are blind and deaf to your body’s surroundings, though you can feel and are aware if you take damage. If your body is moved, the spell ends. If your target is awakened, the spell ends.

ONEIROMANCY

1st-Level Divination (Dream, Ritual Only) | Cleric, Druid, Wizard

Casting Time: 10 minutes

Range: Touch

Components: V, S, M (incense and a bit of mushroom)

Duration: Concentration, 4 or 6 hours (see below)

Dreams can be gateways to understanding, and you can induce such prophetic and insightful dreams in yourself and others. You touch a willing creature of your choice. The creature immediately falls into an enchanted dream state and remains for an entire long rest (4 or 6 hours, depending on their race) unless awakened or if they choose to end the spell early. During this long rest, they experience dreams and visions centering around an event or question of their choice, specified at the casting of the spell. The dreams may be literal, or they may be wrapped in symbolism, omens, and metaphor and left to the dreamer to interpret. This dream state counts as sleep or meditation for the purposes of a long rest.

If the target’s sleep is interrupted, the dreams induced by this spell end. The target may still complete a long rest and gain the benefits of said rest, but they do not return to their previous dreams.

Elves and other creatures with immunity to magical sleep choose whether or not to be affected by this spell.

This spell has no effect on constructs or undead.

PHANTASM

6th-Level Illusion (Dream, Ritual Only) | Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Casting Time: 10 minutes

Range: Self

Components: V, S, M (a sympathetic item from the target, a pinch of grave dirt, and 5,000 gp worth of powdered sapphire, which the spell consumes)

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

You reach out with your consciousness and influence the dreams of another creature. The creature must be on the same plane of existence as you and have a minimum Intelligence score of 7. If the target is not asleep or in meditation (in the case of elves or similar races) when the spell is cast, the spell fails. This spell has no effect on constructs or undead.

Your target must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC. On a failure, their dream becomes a nightmare, and they take 4d10 psychic damage. On a success, they take half as much damage, the spell ends, and you take the same amount of psychic damage as you are shoved from the dream. At the start of each of their turns, the target repeats the saving throw, taking an additional 4d10 damage on a failed save. Once the target succeeds on their saving throw, they are immune to this spell for the next 7 days. The target cannot wake themselves, but if they are awakened by an outside force or if they fall to 0 hit points, the spell ends.

If the target succeeds on their saving throw, they may attempt a DC 20 Wisdom (Insight) check. On a success, if they are familiar with you, they recognize you as the attacker. If they are unfamiliar with you, they do not recognize you, though you may seem strangely familiar if the two of you meet at a later time, and you may even evoke feelings of unease.

For the duration of the spell, your body lies in repose in the location you cast the spell. You are blind and deaf to your body's surroundings, though you can feel and are aware if you take damage. If your body is moved, the spell ends. If your target is awakened, the spell ends.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell at 7th level or higher, you deal an additional 1d10 psychic damage per spell slot above 6th (5d10 at 7th level, 6d10 at 8th level, 7d10 at 9th level).

KALIKAMOREA, THE DREAMER

Between the Triple Spires hovered a cloud over a mile in diameter, its hazy edges just out of reach of the cupolas at their tops. The cloud's appearance, whether fluffy and white or dark and stormy, depended entirely on the mood of its inhabitant: an ancient cloud dragon known as Kalikamore, the Dreamer.

Kalikamore was already ancient when she came to the Tomierran, and history is unclear if she made her home there and the elves built their city around her or if the elves had already established their home within the Tomierran when she arrived. Whatever the case, the cloud dragon and the court beneath her existed in harmony for ages.

Kalikamore rarely left her cloud. Those who wished an audience would climb to the apex of one of the spires to petition the dragon. If she were in a welcoming mood or if the elf was one of her favorites (and make no mistake, she had her favorites), Kalikamore would initiate a telepathic bond between the two. Conversations with the Dreamer could

last for hours or even days, and often the elf involved would meditate far longer than necessary once they descended the spire, their exhausted mind struggling to process everything they had learned from the dragon.

When the elves left for the Summer Lands and the Triple Spires collapsed, Kalikamore's cloud dispersed, and she disappeared. Some claim she was invited to accompany the elves on their exodus, some believe she fled across the lands to the east, and still others whisper that perhaps she never existed in the first place—merely a collective dream of the elves.

Tears of the Dreamer. Scattered throughout the ruins of the Cloud Dragon Court are strange crystals. About the size of a man's palm, these pear-shaped gems are cold to the touch and faceted as if cut and polished, though they've never felt the bite of a grindstone. The gemstones are usually found in shades of blue, green, or white, though reds, oranges, and yellows have also been discovered. There is only one black stone known in existence. The jewels are of pristine clarity and flawless in every aspect.

These crystals are known as the Tears of the Dreamer and hold memories and magical essence within them. The jewels can be ground into a fine gem dust and used in place of spell components.

Additionally, if a PC studies the depths of one, they gain access to a memory locked within. Glimpsed in fleeting images, half-heard words, and vague emotional impressions, the memory is from one of the former residents of the Cloud Dragon Court, typically an elf (though it's not unheard of to glimpse the memory of a servant). Each holds at least one memory, though some have been found with multiple related memories.

Experiencing a particularly vivid memory can convey knowledge to the viewer, and in some cases, the viewer has temporarily gained a particular skill, though the working knowledge fades fairly quickly.

So far, none have been found to hold a memory from Kalikamoreia, though scholars and treasure hunters alike hold out hope to one day find such a stone.

TEARS OF THE DREAMER

Wondrous Item,
Rarity Varies by Color

This tear-shaped gemstone is roughly the size of an adult human’s palm. Though cold to the touch, it hums with mystical vitality, and fleeting images can be glimpsed along its surface.

A creature may spend a short rest meditating on the images within. During their meditation, they experience a memory held within the Tear, as determined by the GM. When they complete the meditation, the creature gains one proficiency, as noted in the table below. This benefit lasts for eight hours. Only one creature may gain this benefit at a time, and the item cannot be used in this way again until the next dawn.

Additionally, a Tear can be ground into a fine gem dust that can be used in place of the spell components of equivalent monetary value. Doing so destroys the Tear. The worth of the gem dust

is noted in the chart below. If the spell consumes the spell components, it instead consumes the equivalent value of dust.



TEARS OF THE DREAMER

d100	GEM COLOR	RARITY	SKILL	VALUE
1–20	Blue	Rare	Perception or Investigation	5,000 gp
21–40	Green	Rare	Insight or Deception	5,000 gp
41–60	White	Rare	Medicine or Nature	5,000 gp
61–69	Yellow	Very Rare	Sleight of Hand, Acrobatics, or Forgery Kit	10,000 gp
70–78	Orange	Very Rare	Alchemists Tools, Arcana, Martial Ranged Weapons	10,000 gp
79–87	Red	Very Rare	Thieves’ Tools, Stealth, Medium Armor	10,000 gp
88–96	Purple	Very Rare	Navigator’s Tools, Survival, Martial Melee Weapons	10,000 gp
97–100	Black	Legendary	Any three proficiencies (player’s choice)	50,000 gp

SUMMER GARDENS (GENNECKA FOREST)

The Summer Gardens, also known as Osilessidra after its queen, lie hidden deep within the Gennecka Forest. Travel to the city during its height was daunting for those not skilled in the arcane. The only reliable way to reach the city was via fey roads, and traveling the trails through the forest was a feat only undertaken by the most determined. This was by design, for while Queen Osilessi did not outright ban those not of elven blood from her realm, she looked for more subtle ways to discourage them from entering her borders unless specifically invited.

Once a retreat for the elves of Midgard, Osilessidra was a city of pristine gardens, greenhouses, and conservatories of all types, filled with carefully cultivated (and heavily protected) plants from the Summer Lands themselves, offering respite to those homesick for the Elflands. The city also boasted vast libraries, filled with magical and mundane tomes of all sorts. Making the trek to Osilessidra was dangerous, but many scholars deemed the quest worth the risk for even the barest of glimpses of the vast knowledge held within its marbled halls. Study was popular here, not just of literature but of the arts of all kinds, and it was not uncommon for elven bards to spend several seasons wandering the halls and gardens in the process of honing their craft or to find luminaries reclining on elegant cushions, sketching the blossoms and each other.

Now, the Summer Gardens are but a wild and crumbling shadow of what they once were. Much of the grounds have fallen to time and have been reclaimed by the forest, save for the few chambers still tended to by the Steadfast.

Alabaster Libraries. Maintained by the Steadfast, the Alabaster Libraries are housed in the west wing of the queen's palace. The rooms themselves are kept locked, opened

once a day when the gnomes enter to dust shelves, polish furniture, and tend to the tomes that line the walls. The gnomes that work the Alabaster Libraries know exactly what books reside within, their precise location, and their condition, and notice immediately if something is out of place or otherwise amiss.

Alongside the treasures of knowledge, the Alabaster Libraries contain multitudes of trinkets and treasures in the form of paintings, sculptures, ancient maps, bookends, and priceless tchotchkes displayed upon the shelves. Any one of these could fetch a high price to the right collector, but retrieving it out from under the nose of the protective Steadfast and getting back out of the Gennecka unscathed would be a challenge indeed.

Gardens. Many of the carefully tended flora from the Summer Lands have long since withered to dust, but rumors persist in certain circles that rare and wondrous plants can be found in the ruins of the Summer Gardens. Rumors also claim that monstrous carnivorous plants roam the grounds and are happy to make a meal of any wayward traveler. Nonetheless, some botanists and alchemists are willing to pay a hefty amount of coin to adventurers willing to brave the risks to bring back cuttings or live plants.

Within the gardens is an elaborate hedge maze of rose bushes that has somehow remained pristine despite the passing of centuries, a twin to the Prickling Maze of the Court of Roses in the Arbonesse. Unlike the roses found in the Prickling Maze though, the roses here are not sentient, nor do they speak. They do, however, give off a heady fragrance that can bewilder and charm those not of elven blood. Any creature who enters the maze may find themselves lost, not just confounded by the twists and turns of the pathway but beguiled by the roses themselves.

Though the Blood Duke Rüzgar, ruler of the nearby province of Zaldiri, is keen on the forest, an annual tribute of rare mushroom elixirs from the Steadfast to sooth the ancient cave dragon's old battle scars—along with the arrows and spells of the Gennecka's other inhabitants—keep the morza satisfied for now.

Treasury. Servants and their children were not the only things left behind by the elves when they left Midgard. In many cases, anything too difficult to transport was abandoned—including vast treasures. It is rumored that, hidden somewhere on the grounds of the Summer Gardens, is the treasury, still full of all the priceless art and treasures the residents were forced to abandoned. But the elves built their locks to last, and their traps were deadly.

THE STEADFAST

When the Last Horn sounded and the Great Retreat began, the elves left much behind, including their gnomish and halfling servitors. Many of these servants ventured out into the wide world beyond, embracing new opportunities, but a few remained behind to maintain what they could of their former homes in case the elves ever returned. Even many of these departed the empty estates after some time, realizing the futility of serving masters that had long since abandoned them.

Though generations have passed since the elves left Midgard, the descendants of gnomish servants still remain within the Summer Gardens. They call themselves the Steadfast, clinging to their duties and loyalties in a way they see as honorable and dedicated. Despite their determination and the occasional addition to their ranks, the numbers of Steadfast have dwindled over the centuries. Currently, they only have enough manpower to maintain a few of the gardens' chambers, and they focus their attentions on the Alabaster Libraries, the throne room, and the queen's chambers. Everything else has fallen into disrepair.

WILLOW COURT OF THE WINEWOOD

A relatively small court, the halls of the Willow Court rested in the southeastern portion of the Winewood in Rumela. Nestled up against the protective wall formed by the Griffoncrag, the Willow Court enjoyed the fruits of the forest and the mountains alike. Orchards were cultivated within the Winewood. Terraced vineyards were built up the steep slopes of the Griffoncrag while precious metals were pulled from mines at the base of the mountains and griffons roosted in their peaks. While the bounty from their trees didn't quite match the harvests in the Summer Gardens, their wines never quite lived up to those created in Dornig, and their griffons were never quite as grand as the ones found in the Margreve, the Willow Court nonetheless carved out their own name.

When the Mharoti claimed Rumela for themselves, the borders of the Winewood shrank inward as the dragonkin felled the trees along the edges for their new construction. Still, the depths of the forest remain mostly untouched and unexplored, save for the druids who make their homes within. But even they avoid the ruins of the Willow Court, concerning themselves more with the dragonkin at their eastern and southern borders.

GRIFFONS OF THE WILLOW COURT

The Griffoncrag are aptly named. In the warmer months, it is not unusual to see young griffons wheeling and playing amidst the thermal updrafts or to spot a solitary adult or pair hunting far afield. The golden griffons of the Griffoncrag are smaller and faster than the breeds found in the Margreve or Zobeck.

The ruins of the Willow Court hold the remains of stables and rookeries, now empty of anything but dust and mold. The griffon riders of the Willow Court often traveled to the Griffon Court to train and then

returned to train others. The griffons of the Willow Court were kept more for sport and pleasure than for protection though. While remnants of griffon barding and polearms for griffon-mounted combat can be found, the majority of the saddles and bridals that remain are sleeker and more ornate, crafted for comfort and prestige rather than battle.

WILLOW COURT WINE

Made from the grapes grown on the western slopes of the Griffoncrag and fermented in clear mountain spring water, Willow Court wine was once enjoyed by the elves of the Winewood in vast amounts. One of the few exports from the city, it was enjoyed even as far as the Griffon Court in the Margreve Forest (though many of the Griffon Court preferred the sweeter wine made in Thorn). The vintners of the Willow Court each had their own enchantments that they wove into their fermentation vats and aging barrels, trade secrets that maintained proper temperature, pressure, and sugar levels to create the perfect wine.

When the Great Retreat occurred, much of the wine was left behind, either in barrels in the warehouses tucked at the base of the Griffoncrag or in bottles in the wine cellars throughout the households of the Willow Court. Though much of this wine has been plundered already, finding a forgotten bottle or a hidden cask might still be possible. A bottle of such recovered wine would make a fine gift to an elf of any sufficient age and memory or to a noble of discerning taste.

Wild Fermentation. Sometime after the Great Retreat, some of the enchanted fermentation vats and aging barrels were destroyed when the roof of the building they were stored in collapsed. The enchantments seeped from the shattered wood along with the liquid within, permeating the soil and water and releasing their spores into the air. The circle of druids who now reside within the Winewood (see *Warlock 7: Fey Courts*)

utilize the forest's unique environment to their advantage, but outsiders may find the atmosphere (not to mention the smell) off-putting. Additionally, foodstuffs brought within the Winewood, especially fresh fruits, quickly go sour and become inedible unless magically protected.

LOST ARBONESSE

Unlike the other lost elven courts listed here, Lost Arbonesse was not abandoned but destroyed. The tales tell that more than 400 years ago, Isonade, the great beast, rose from the depths of the Uttermost Sea and dragged the northwestern portion of the Arbonesse into the sea. Now, the ruins of the court lie beneath the waves as the stumps of the great trees and shattered remnants of its glorious structures dot the coastline.

But what waits within the drowned elven city is a mystery to most. Sailing the waters is hazardous at best, for the hidden ruins can pierce the hull of even the most cautious ship. Spirits of the unquiet dead and strange creatures from the depths haunt the coastline and the waters themselves, quickly stymying any attempted excursions.

The few elves in Midgard that remember Lost Arbonesse before it fell to the sea refuse to speak of it, whether out of fear or sorrow, and seem uninterested in making any major efforts to explore the ruins. Better to let the ghosts (and their memories) rest.

DROWNED TRINKETS

Strange treasures often turn up on the coastline where Lost Arbonesse sank. Shattered pieces of furniture, broken trinkets, and crumpled odds and ends all make their way to the sand even now, centuries after the city's destruction.

The strangest, and possibly saddest though, are the bits of sea glass that roll onto the shore, revealed each day by the receding tide. This glass—not just blues and greens but vivid reds, purples, yellows, and oranges—are



the remnants of the elaborate stained-glass windows that once resided in the city's grand halls, and they glitter and gleam in the sand all along the coast. However, these beautiful, almost organic-looking baubles are shunned by the locals. It's considered bad luck to take them from the shore. More than one story circulates of an elf or elfmarked that collected a piece of the tumbled glass as a memento to a lost loved one and was later driven mad by haunted whisperings or found drowned by saltwater in their own bed, nowhere near the ocean.

BEACON FOR THE UNDEAD

The destruction of Lost Arbonesse was an act so terrible, so tragic, it sent shockwaves through the region and fundamentally altered the land and its arcane underpinnings. Countless undead were created that day, not only from the citizens and visitors that drowned beneath the waves but by a massive influx of pain, sorrow, and rage. The coastline and sunken city teem with ghosts, zombies, and other undead, both those that were created there and those that have been drawn to the region like moths to a flame.

Some of these undead are much like the others any adventurer would find at all points of the map. Some, however, bear unique features that have only been seen in the area of Lost Arbonesse.

Water Wights and Brinemaidens. Many of the undead found in Lost Arbonesse display similarities to the more intelligent undead found throughout Midgard, but they have an unnerving affinity for the water in and around the ruins of the elven city. They bear elven features, and some even wear scraps of armor said to bear the crest of the houses lost beneath the sea.

WATER WIGHT

An undead elf, draped in the rotting trappings of a long-lost civilization, shambles toward you through the surf.

Similar in disposition and behavior to common wights, the water wight is nonetheless unique to Lost Arbonesse. Wielding rusted and rotting weapons of the lost elvish culture, the water wight is a vengeful and unforgiving foe.

Lost Honor. The water wights were once soldiers of the great elvish houses of what is now Lost Arbonesse. They rage against their helplessness at the fate of their city and their loved ones, and seethe at the injustice. They continue to mindlessly protect their houses and lands, with little regard to the fact that they—and everyone they knew—are dead. They cannot be reasoned with, unable to face the truth of their tragic end.

Undead Nature. A water wight doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

WATER WIGHT

Medium Undead, Neutral Evil

Armor Class 14 (studded leather)

Hit Points 45 (6d8 + 18)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws Con +5

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +3

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages the languages it knew in life

Challenge 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Aversion to Dry Ground. When the water wight is on dry ground, it has disadvantage on attack rolls.



ACTIONS

Multiattack. The water wight makes two Longsword attacks. It can use Drown in place of one of these attacks.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Drown. The water wight locks eyes with its enemy, conjuring within its target the raging waters of the sea. The target must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure,

salt water fills the target's mouth, throat, and lungs, and the target has no breath left and immediately begins to drown. The target may repeat the saving throw at the end of their turn. On a success, the effect ends. The effect ends if the target or the water wight is reduced to 0 hit points. A target that dies in this fashion rises 24 hours later as a **zombie** under the water wight's control. The wight can have no more than six zombies under its control at one time.

BRINEMAIDEN

A ghostly figure of an elven woman floats toward you through the water, its empty eye sockets fixed on yours, its mouth open impossibly wide in an unearthly wail.

Cousin to banshees and drowned maidens, the brinemaiden is the lost spirit of an elven woman drowned within Lost Arbonesse. She floats along the coastline and even through the submerged ruins, retracing steps she took often in life. A brinemaiden is an angry and frightened spirit, lashing out at any nearby living creature in her confusion.

Bound to Baubles. A brinemaiden need not be confined to the place of her death and may be bound instead to an item from her life. A trinket, a piece of jewelry, or even the last thing she saw as she drowned can be the tether for her rage-filled soul. Many brinemaids are bound to bits of Lost Arbonesse sea glass, as the shattered remnants of stained-glass windows filled the swirling waters around them as they drowned. Individuals that wander away from the ruins of Lost Arbonesse with one of these prizes often inadvertently brings a brinemaiden with them.

Undead Nature. A brinemaiden doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

BRINEMAIDEN

Medium Undead, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 58 (13d8)

Speed 0 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover), swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
1 (-5)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	17 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +2, Cha +5

Damage Resistances acid, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical weapons

Damage Immunities cold, necrotic, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages the languages she knew in life.

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Detect Life. The brinemaiden can magically sense the presence of creatures up to 5 miles away that aren't undead or constructs. She knows the general direction they're in but not exact locations.

Incorporeal Movement. The brinemaiden can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

ACTIONS

Corrupting Touch. *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (3d6 + 2) necrotic damage.

Calls of the Lost. Each creature within 60 feet of the brinemaiden must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, they must use all of their movement and must take the dash action to move directly toward and into the nearest body of water, as the haunting wails of the drowned call out to them. The creature may take no other actions, bonus actions, or reactions. The target may repeat the saving throw at the end of their turn. A creature who reaches the water while under these effects swims (or walks, if they cannot swim) their full speed directly away from the shore until the effect ends. If there is no water nearby, the creature spends their turn wracked with mournful sobs.

Wail (1/day). The banshee releases a mournful wail, provided that she isn't in sunlight. This wail has no effect on constructs and undead. All other creatures within 30 feet of her that can hear her must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, the creature drops to 0 hit points. On a success, a creature takes 10 (3d6) psychic damage.

WINDRUNNER ELVES

by Robert Fairbanks

Elusive, eccentric, and unpredictable, windrunner elves have quietly traversed Midgard's vast central grasslands for millennia. These diminutive nomads roaming the steppes and plains are thought to originally hail from the elven capital of Sephaya, long since abandoned during the Great Retreat. When the Sephayan nobility withdrew, they fled to the Arbonesse along the fey roads. However, legends hint some were denied sanctuary, and those numbers, with households and retinues in tow, continued onward, disappearing into the then-uncharted east. Whether this second migration was by force or by choice remains a mystery. Many scholars suggest windrunners are the descendants of those unsettled elven expatriates. Less popular lines of research have led experts to suggest windrunners may have origins nearer to the mountains of Beldestan or points even farther east. Aggressively autonomous, the windrunner clans have little love for the remnants of the scattered elves. The notion of owing allegiance to the elves of the west is considered offensive, and outright hostility can result at the mere suggestion of fidelity to the Imperatrix of the Grand Duchy or the River Lords of the Arbonesse.

After the Great Retreat. Several windrunner traditions claim that sometime after the Great Retreat and their expulsion from the Arbonesse, another series of schisms formed among the fleeing Sephayan refugees. Some academics cite treachery and scandal among a still panicky, opportunistic Sephayan nobility. Others speculate the approach to Demon Mountain as somehow a magical or psychic initiator to the four migrations. Even in those times, the mountain was an ill-omened place. From far afield, the great Sephayan sorcerers and wizards could sense the mountain as a place of vast and tumultuous energies, which only added to the elven nobilities' foreboding and unrest. In either case, a third elven dispersal had begun in the shadow of what would later be called Demon Mountain.

The Windrunner Clans. Four great houses now parted ways. Some skirted the Wormwood, disappearing northeast of the Demon Mountain. The majority turned south, toward wide, rolling, coastal plains and gentler climes. Four elven bloodlines, who over centuries would divide, survive, and remerge, ultimately "stabilized" into the eight windrunner clans that today roam the windy plains and trackless steppe-lands.



For nearly all windrunners, primary subsistence is derived from nomadic herding. With the aid of trained herding and hunting dogs, the clans cohabitate and tend to antelope, musk ox, and bison. Windrunner societies are self-governing tribal confederacies, built on ancestral ties and political alliances. They are a fiercely self-reliant people: passionate, territorial, and ardently devoted to their post-exodus way of life.

The clans build no fences and do not believe in the ownership of land. They do, however, fiercely defend sacred sites and hunting grounds, even from one another. Long-standing feuds occur regularly over water, grazing, and wintering rights.

Characteristics. Windrunners are slight even by elven standards, and individuals reaching a height of 5 feet are rare. They keep their hair braided, knotted, pinned, or even shorn off to withstand the relentless winds. Windrunner attire usually consists of tanned and dyed hides and furs. They adore tattoos and piercings and make intricate fetishes to denote clan and status.

Elves Aloft

While the windrunners' use of kites is noteworthy, it is somewhat overwrought in the minds of many. Travelers' tales, however, keep getting more elaborate with each telling.

Typical kite use for the clans is to cross chasms and other treacherous land, launching from horseback or descending from precipices. They also use them for competitive events and for herding livestock and marking land for grazing and water. They are storied for sending aloft tethered lookouts via kite. Distant clusters of kites can often be seen fluttering above their herds.

Their rain wagons, or water wains, one of the few wheeled conveyances used by windrunners, are fitted with a channeling system for the collection, storage, and distribution of rainwater.

Equipment of the Windrunners

The windrunners have developed many tools for hunting on the planes.

Birding Shaft. These short, thick-shafted arrows have blunted, weighted tips. Instead of damage, a creature hit by one must make a Constitution saving throw with a DC 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Dexterity modifier. On a failed save, the creature is stunned until the end of its next turn.

Lasso. The target of a successful lasso attack is grappled and restrained. While the grapple persists, you may pull the target by 5 feet per turn as a bonus action or dismount a mounted target, knocking it prone. The lasso has a 15-foot reach.

A creature can use its action to make a Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check (target's choice) contested by your Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check (your choice), freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. Dealing 5 slashing damage to the lasso (AC 10) also frees the creature without harming it, ending the effect and destroying the lasso.

Windrunner Bolas. When a creature is hit by a ranged weapon attack made with bolas, it must make a Strength or Dexterity saving throw (target's choice) with a DC 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Strength or Dexterity modifier (your choice). On a failed save, the creature is restrained until the bolas are removed. On a successful save, the creature takes damage but is not entangled.

A creature can use its action to make a DC 12 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. Dealing 5 slashing damage to the bolas (AC 10) also frees the creature without harming it, ending the effect and destroying the bolas.

Windrunner Boomerang. A boomerang thrown within its short range returns to you after it is thrown. If you have a Dexterity

ITEM	COST	WEIGHT
Ammunition		
Birding Shaft	2 gp	1 1/2 lb.

NAME	COST	DAMAGE	WEIGHT	PROPERTIES
Martial Melee Weapons				
Lasso	5 gp	—	6 lb.	Finesse, reach (15 feet), special (see below)
Martial Ranged Weapons				
Windrunner Bolas	25 gp	1d4 bludgeoning	3 lb.	Finesse, light, thrown (range 30/60), special (see below)
Windrunner Boomerang	15 gp (standard)/ 25 gp (bladed)	1d4 bludgeoning (standard)/1d4 slashing (bladed)	3 lb. (standard)/ 4 lb. (bladed)	Finesse, light, special (see below), thrown (range 100/300)

score of 15 or higher, you automatically catch the returning boomerang. If not, you must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw to catch it. On a failed save, the boomerang lands at your feet. If you fail the save by 5 or more, the boomerang strikes you, dealing 1d4 bludgeoning damage (or slashing damage if it is a bladed boomerang).

Magic Items of the Windrunners

The windrunners favor magic items that are especially useful on the Rothenian Plane.

CEDARSKIN CUIRASS

Armor (Studded Leather), Very Rare (Requires Attunement)

This lightweight, fragrant piece is finely crafted of doeskin and reinforced with strips of woven cedar bark and rawhide. The armor is treated as +1 *studded leather*. In addition, while you wear it, you have advantage on any saving throws related to poison and disease, and difficult terrain doesn't impede your movement.

SAIGA HELM

Wondrous Item, Very Rare (Requires Attunement)

This antelope skull is fashioned as a helm and engraved with druidic sigils. While wearing it, you gain a +1 bonus to armor class and are immune to the stunned condition.

Additionally, you can headbutt an opponent. On a hit, the target takes 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage and must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

SNOWSHOE RABBIT SNOWBOOTS

Wondrous Item, Very Rare (Requires Attunement)

These low, soft boots are fashioned of enchanted snowshoe rabbit pelts and have wide, overlong soles. Icy terrain doesn't impede your movement, and you have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made to hide in snow.

Additionally, on speaking the command word, you gain +15 feet of movement, plus your jump distance is tripled. When this property has been used for a total of 1 hour, the magic ceases to function until you finish a short or long rest.

WIND KUKRI

Weapon (Dagger), Rare (Requires Attunement)

You gain a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls with this magic weapon.

If wielding a pair of *wind kukri*, you gain a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with each weapon. In addition, you gain the following abilities while wielding the pair:

- Once per turn per kukri, when used as a thrown weapon, it flies back to your hand safely after each attack roll. If you don't have a hand free, the weapon lands at your feet.
- When you score a critical hit with a kukri, the target takes an additional 2 (1d4) thunder damage.
- A target hit by both kukris in the same round must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be pushed back 5 feet and deafened until the end of their next turn.

Spells of the Windrunners

While windrunner elves certainly acknowledge the existence of other peoples' deities, they worship none, though they do have a rich druidic tradition and sorcerers are not uncommon.

BREEZE WALKER

2nd-Level Transmutation | Druid

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: Self

Components: V, S, M (a pheasant feather)

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

Choosing a direction, you summon a strong, steady breeze to swirl beneath your feet and propel you. You levitate to a sustained height of 3 feet for the duration, and travel in the chosen direction is at 150% of your movement. Travel in any other direction is at 50% of your movement.

While mounted, your mount's movement is affected as well.

WINDBLOWN

4th-Level Evocation | Sorcerer

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: Touch

Components: V, S, M
(a pinch of quail down)

Duration: Concentration,
up to 1 minute

You cause a column of air to swiftly launch the target creature or object up to 100 feet straight up. A creature can make a Dexterity saving throw to grab onto a fixed object it can reach, thus avoiding being launched. If some solid object (such as a ceiling) is encountered on the way up, the target strikes it just as if they had fallen the same distance. Once at its apex, the target remains buoyant, bobbing in midair, and will be blown along with the prevailing wind. When the spell ends, the target falls to the ground. This spell has no effect on flying creatures.

Windrunner NPCs

Silent figures appear all around you in a heartbeat. Dozens rise from the tall savannah grass like ghosts. These small, hide-clad elves seem to bristle at your approach, heavy bone knives clenched in their tattooed fists.

ELF, WINDRUNNER SCOUT

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Any Non-Lawful Alignment

Armor Class 15 (studded leather)

Hit Points 52 (8d8 +16)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	9 (-1)

Skills Animal Handling +4, Perception +4, Stealth +5, Survival +4

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Elvish

Challenge 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2



Fey Ancestry. The elf has advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put them to sleep.

Keen Hearing and Sight. The elf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or sight.

Pack Tactics. The elf has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of their allies is within 5 ft. of the creature and the ally isn't Incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The elf makes two Bone Knives attacks or one Bone Knives and one Lasso attack.

Bone Knives. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) slashing damage.

Lasso. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* Target is grappled (escape DC 14). While the grapple persists, the target is restrained. The elf can use a bonus action to pull a grappled target up to 5 feet or to dismount a mounted target, knocking it prone.

Boomerang. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 100/300, one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) bludgeoning damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Fast Hands. If the elf hits the same target with two Bone Knives attacks in the same round, they can make an additional two Bone Knives attacks against the same target.

ELF, WINDRUNNER SKIRMISHER

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Any Non-Lawful Alignment

Armor Class 16 (studded leather)

Hit Points 112 (15d8 + 45)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)



Saving Throws Dex +7, Wis +5

Skills Animal Handling +5, Perception +5,
Stealth +7, Survival +5

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages Common, Elvish

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Fey Ancestry. The elf has advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put them to sleep.

Keen Hearing and Sight. The elf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or sight.

Mounted Warrior. When mounted, the elf has advantage on attacks against unmounted creatures smaller than its mount. If the elf's mount is subjected to an effect that allows it to take half damage with a successful Dexterity saving throw, the mount instead takes no damage if it succeeds on the saving throw and half damage if it fails.

Pack Tactics. The elf has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of their allies is within 5 ft. of the creature and the ally isn't Incapacitated.

Precision Shot. When the elf attacks with a ranged or thrown melee weapon, their attacks ignore half cover and don't have disadvantage at long range.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The elf makes three Obsidian Scimitar attacks or three Shortbow attacks.

Obsidian Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) slashing damage. For each hit a target takes from this attack, the target takes an additional cumulative +1 slashing damage at the start of each of its turns, so for example, three hits on a target would mean an additional +3 slashing damage per turn. Any amount of magical healing or a DC 13 Wisdom (Medicine) check stops this extra damage (and resets the count). Constructs and undead are immune to this extra damage.

Bolas. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 30/60, one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d4 + 4) bludgeoning damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength or Dexterity saving throw (target's choice) or be restrained. A restrained target is freed with a successful DC 12 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check or by dealing 5 slashing damage to the bolas (AC 10).

Shortbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 80/320, one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage.

Spellcasting. The elf casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 11):

- 2/day each: *hunter's mark*, *waft**
 - 1/day each: *pass without trace*, *thunderous charge**
- (* See *Deep Magic*.)

FABLED ELVISH MAGIC ITEMS

by Jeremy Hochhalter

Elves have left their mark across the history of the world as empires rose, fell, and disappeared. Throughout the centuries, elven heroes and leaders etched their legends into the annals of time. There are legendary elves whose names are spoken of in reverence—and sometimes in fear—even to this day. Objects crafted for or by those elves still linger in the mortal realm, left behind during the Great Retreat.

Bands of Infernal Favor

This armband is made of two blood-red metal bands, which cross over one another three times. Between the gaps, crystals are set in place, hollow yet surprisingly durable.

To date, only a few of the *Bands of Infernal Favor* have been found, though their current locations are kept a mystery. Long before the rise of the magocracies—when there was still some trust between the elves and the humans—humans gifted the bands to various elven patrons: mages, druids, and paladins. Ostensibly, the bands were created to boost the wearer's connection with a familiar, companion, or steed. Highly valued by those who received them, it was unknown that the

true purpose of the strange, twisted metal was the corruption of elvenkind.

Those who passed them along to the elves were devout worshippers of infernal powers who wished to harness the magics wielded by elves. They sought ways to bend elven wills to their favor, granting them access to the shadow roads.

The elves were wary of the purpose that seemed to lurk within the bands, twisting their companions into fiendish forms. Casting them aside, the bands were hidden away from those who might cause harm. A few, however, have remained unaccounted for.

BANDS OF INFERNAL FAVOR

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Properties Require Attunement by a Paladin, Ranger, Sorcerer, Warlock, or Wizard)

While you are both conscious, you and your familiar, animal companion, or steed can't be surprised while you are within 30 feet of each other.

Infernal Favor (Requires Attunement).

As your level increases, you gain the following benefits while using this item. During attunement, and then at dawn of

each day, the bands' spikes press into your flesh, draining blood that fills the crystals held in place by the red metal. This process empowers the bands and drains one Hit Die from you. Hit Dice drained in this manner can be recuperated as normal. If this process is not completed, the bands' abilities do not function for that day.

5th Level. You and your familiar, animal companion, or steed both gain advantage on attacks against a creature if you are both within 5 feet of the creature and neither of you is incapacitated.

Additionally, your familiar, animal companion, or steed's hit points increase by the average of your class Hit Die when you increase in level from now on, including multiclass levels.

9th Level. You gain a +2 bonus to initiative as long as your familiar, animal companion, or steed is within 30 feet of you.

Additionally, your familiar, animal companion, or steed does not die or disappear when they are reduced to 0 hit points. Instead, they are dying and may make death saving throws. You may use an action to spend an available Hit Die to stabilize and heal them for the amount of your Hit Die + your spellcasting modifier.

As a bonus action, you can spend available Hit Dice to heal your familiar, animal companion, or steed.

13th Level. You cause your familiar, animal companion, or steed to magically change into a specific fiend of CR 5 or lower. The target's statistics are replaced by the statistics of the chosen fiend, though it retains its alignment and Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma scores. It also retains all its skill and saving throw proficiencies, in addition to gaining those of the fiend. (The fiend is an average example of the chosen fiend, without any class levels or the Spellcasting trait. The target can't use any legendary actions or lair actions of the new form.)

The target assumes the hit points and Hit Dice of the new form. When it reverts to its normal form, it returns to the number of hit points it had before it was transformed. If it reverts as a result of dropping to 0 hit points, any excess damage carries over to its normal form. As long as the excess damage doesn't reduce its normal form to 0 hit points, it isn't knocked unconscious.

The target can't use any special senses its normal form has unless the fiend has that sense. If the fiend can speak, the target can speak and understand any language known by you.

Any equipment carried by either form falls to the ground when the change occurs unless both forms could hold the equipment.

Once used, the armband can't be used in this way again until the next dawn.

17th Level. Your familiar, animal companion, or steed gain the fiend type, if it does not already have it, as it takes on fiendish features, such as black eyes, horns, or a fiendish hue. It becomes immune to fire and poison damage and can't be poisoned.

As a bonus action, you can spend available Hit Dice to remove hit points from your companion in order to heal yourself. If your companion has changed shape, those hit points are temporary and last for 1 hour or until they are lost from taking damage.

The Price of Attunement. While attuned to the armband, you have disadvantage on Wisdom (Insight) checks as well as Wisdom and Charisma saving throws against fiends. Charisma (Deception) checks made by you against fiends always fail. At any time, a fiend on your plane within 10 miles of you or your companion may use a bonus action to view what you or your companion see and hear.

Crown of the Eagle Emperor

This golden circlet is crafted in realistic detail as if feathers lie atop one another. Despite its age, there is no sign of damage or tarnish.

The Eagle Emperor, his true name now lost to history, ruled at the High Court of Liadmura in the Ironcrags during a time of expansion and military dominance. Though his empire is now gone, his winged emblem

can still be found in the canton. The stories of his heroics and combat prowess are legendary, and woven within them are, what some sages say, hints that the Eagle Emperor was in fact a lycanthrope of some form.

The truth is equally as interesting though. The elven war god, Valeresh, looked favorably upon the Eagle Emperor, bestowing great power upon him. One such



boon was lain upon the emperor's crown, allowing the conqueror to change shape into one of the massive golden eagles favored by his people and even allowing his elven form to take on the attributes of such a creature.

Whether Valeresh abandoned the Eagle Emperor or it was simply a matter of fate, no one knows, but during a terrific battle, the elven lord flew high above the armies that battled on the ground, dueling with riders of other winged beasts. Though the tide of battle was in his favor, the Eagle Emperor was suddenly struck down, the magic that sustained his transformation eradicated. His fall took him away from the battle but not before his army saw his plummeting form. Disheartened, the elven troops retreated to find their fallen lord, of which they found no sign. It is said by some that a soldier in that army found and spirited away the *Crown of the Eagle Emperor*, either to keep it safe or to use for their own purposes. Other legends state that the crown was nowhere to be found, taken back by Valeresh for the Eagle Emperor's failure. This may be true, as their loss as this battle marked the beginning of the fall of the empire.

CROWN OF THE EAGLE EMPEROR

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Properties Require Attunement)

While wearing the crown, you have advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that require sight.

The Eagle Incarnate (Requires Attunement).

As your level increases, you gain the following benefits while using this item.

5th Level. Using an action, golden eagle wings appear from your back, granting you a flying speed of 60 feet. Once used, the crown can't be used in this way again until the next dawn.

9th Level. You gain +10 to initiative and can't be surprised.

13th Level. You can use your action to polymorph into an eagle-humanoid hybrid or into an eagle or back into your true form. Your statistics, other than your AC, are the same in each form. You choose whether your equipment falls to the ground, merges into your new form, or is worn by it. Worn equipment functions as normal, but the GM decides whether it is practical for the new form to wear a particular piece of equipment, based on the creature's shape and size. Your equipment doesn't change size or shape to match the new form, and any equipment the new form can't wear must either fall to the ground or merge with you. Equipment that merges with you has no effect until you leave the form. Your hybrid form has wings that grant you a flying speed of 60 feet, and you can hover.

While in the hybrid form, you gain two natural weapon attacks which you are proficient with: Talons, which deal 2d6 + your Strength modifier slashing damage, and Beak, which deals 1d6 + your Strength modifier piercing damage. This damage is magical.

In addition, you are resistant to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing weapons from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Once used, the crown can't be used in this way again until the next dawn, except to revert to your true form

17th Level. You are immune to damage from nonmagical weapons. In addition, you may use the 5th-level and 13th-level abilities of the crown twice per day. You also gain the Piercing Cry action below.

Piercing Cry (Recharge 6). You can release a screeching cry in a 30-foot cone. Creatures within this cone must succeed on a DC 18 Constitution saving throw or take 8d6 thunder damage and be deafened. Creatures that succeed on the saving throw take half the amount of damage and are not deafened.

Gorget of the Explorer

This dark-leather gorget is finely worked with a beautiful compass rose. Vines and various flowers decorate the compass.

Scholars argue whether this gorget was created by Emperor Xindrical or if it was made for the ruler that was commonly

referred to as the Explorer. In any case, legend tells that Xindrical, ruler of the first elven capital on Midgard, used the gorget's magic to travel fantastic distances in the blink of an eye. What's more, when he traveled on foot, he was able to fend off dangers that left others in dire straits.



After the expansion of the elven empires across the face of Midgard, the gorget was lost to time, though vague references to heroes and villains with similar abilities pop up in scholarly texts. Then again, such tales are often the stuff of chapbooks and bard songs, so it is difficult to assess if and where the gorget actually appears since being lost to the Explorer Emperor.

GORGET OF THE EXPLORER

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Properties Require Attunement)

You recall any regions you've traveled and can't get lost in those places unless the area has changed excessively or is hidden by magic. Spending 1 minute in deliberation, you can always determine which direction is north.

World Walker (Requires Attunement). As your level increases, you gain the following benefits while using this item.

5th Level. You have advantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks. Spending 1 minute, you can determine how far away the closest ley line is and in which direction it lies.

9th Level. You are not affected by difficult terrain.

As a bonus action, you can activate the gorget to begin creating difficult terrain in your wake for up to 600 feet. This may appear as ice, vines, loose rubble, or similar, but it does not deal damage. Once used, the gorget can't be used in this way again until the next dawn.

13th Level. While at a ley line, you can attune the gorget to that point by spending 1 minute focusing. You may only have one attuned point at a time.

You can teleport yourself and up to eight willing creatures to an attuned point. Once used, the gorget can't be used in this way again until the next dawn.

17th Level. Once per day, you can use an action to choose an elemental type: acid, cold, fire, lightning, poison, or thunder. Aligning the gorget to that type alters the coloring of the decorative bits on the gorget and grants you immunity to that damage type. At dawn of the next day, this immunity fades and must be reactivated.

Sarastra's Baubles

The baubles are a set of four glass globes, fragile in appearance, which hang from a small brass fixture. Other bits of gems, beads, and glass decorate the fine strings from which the baubles dangle. The brass plate has an oblong hole from which a leather strap or strong twine may be laced, allowing the baubles to be hung from a staff or belt loop.

Long before she was the Queen of Night and Magic, Sarastra dabbled in magic that others might label as questionable. The daughter of High Queen Lelliana of Thorn experimented with and created many magic devices before she was banished, though most were confiscated and destroyed. One object that slipped past the watchful eyes of her mother and those sent to scour the lands for such magic were a set of ornaments. Called *Sarastra's Baubles* by those who know of their existence, they are highly sought by scholars, mages, and adventurers alike. Separated from the baubles when she was exiled, Sarastra herself would like to regain possession of these horrid trinkets.

Created by a younger yet no-less cruel Sarastra, one should not be shocked to find out that the future goddess and ruler of the dark fey formed these baubles to torment those who guarded her. Or when necessary, the baubles were used to capture those who learned Sarastra's devious plots, potential snitches that were never heard from or seen again.

SARASTA'S BAUBLES

Wondrous Item, Fabled (5th-Level and Higher Properties Require Attunement)

You have advantage on Charisma-based ability checks.

Will of the Mistress (Requires Attunement).

As your level increases, you gain the following benefits while using this item.

5th Level. Through the baubles, you are able to cast each of the following spells once per day (saving throw DC 15): *calm emotions*, *charm monster*, *confusion*, *fear*.

9th Level. As an action, you can use a bauble to send one creature within 60 feet that you can see to a demiplane within the bauble. The creature must succeed on a DC 17 Charisma saving throw or be banished. While in the harmless demiplane, the target is incapacitated. Though aware of what is going on outside the bauble, the creature can't communicate beyond its confines. The creature does not hunger, thirst, or age. Poisons and diseases and other damaging effects that affect it are suspended while the creature is banished. A creature that succeeds on its saving throw is immune to the banishing effect of the baubles for the next 24 hours.

A bauble can hold one creature at a time. You can release a banished creature as a bonus action, at which time the creature reappears in the space it left or in the nearest unoccupied space if that space is occupied. If the creature's original space is no longer within 60 feet of the bauble, it appears in a random space within 60 feet of the bauble's location.

A bauble has AC 12, 10 hits points, and will release a banished creature if broken. Broken baubles reform after 1d4 days.

13th Level. You can incite fear in a creature that is being held within a bauble. As an action, you can force the creature to make a DC 18 Charisma saving throw. If it fails, the creature is haunted by formless terrors for 1 minute. During this time, you can use its fear to heal yourself. As a bonus action, you cause the creature to suffer 3d12 psychic damage, and you regain an equal amount of hit points. If a creature is reduced to 0 hit points within a bauble, it falls unconscious for 1d4 hours but is stable.

17th Level. Time spent in a bauble warps a creature's perceptions about you, making it malleable to your orders. Even though you can't make a creature not dislike or hate you, a creature you release can be forced to do your bidding for 1 hour. During that time, the creature is charmed and can't take actions to harm you. If instructed to do something that it would not typically do, such as harm a loved one, it may make a DC 17 Charisma saving throw to refuse, though it remains charmed by you. A charmed creature can't be forced to harm itself or put itself into situations that would cause its death, such as jumping off a cliff.

To recapture a creature, you impinge your will as an action, and the creature must make a DC 17 Charisma saving throw. If it fails, the creature is once again banished within a bauble. If it succeeds though, the creature breaks free of the spell and is immune to the banishing effect of the baubles for the next 24 hours.

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